

CONFLICTS RESOLUTION FRAMEWORK

Honeydew Homes SMP • Staff Guidelines

Overview

This framework guides all staff members through conflict resolution on Honeydew Homes SMP. All disputes are reported via the ticket system with supporting evidence (screenshots, videos, logs, etc.). The burden of proof rests with the accuser, and investigations are conducted fairly and transparently.

Staff Hierarchy & Authority

The following hierarchy determines investigator assignment and appeals authority:

Rank	Role	Authority
1	Owner	Final authority. Cannot be demoted/banned.
2	Head Admin	Investigates staff conflicts. Reviews appeals.
3	Server Admin	Investigates in-game conflicts.
4	DC Admin	Investigates Discord conflicts.

Conflict Types & Investigation

Member-to-Member Conflicts

Includes: Theft, griefing, trading disputes, harassment

Item	Details
Reporting	Ticket system with all evidence (screenshots, videos, chat logs)
Investigator	DC Admin (if Discord) Server Admin (if in-game)
Process	Review logs, chat history, photos, timestamps. Burden of proof on accuser.
Valid Claim	Victim refunded/repaired at no cost. Accuser punished per rules.
Appeal	Accused may appeal via ticket with supporting evidence.
Documentation	Ticket system + modlogs archive

Member-to-Staff Conflicts

Includes: Unfair ban, staff abuse, favoritism accusations

Item	Details
Reporting	Ticket system. DMs to Head Admin may be used to prevent staff interference.
Investigator	Staff member above the accused rank. Neutral investigator if needed.
Process	Same as member-to-member. Burden of proof on accuser.
If Guilty	Accused staff may face demotion, role removal, or ban.
Appeal	Player may appeal via ticket. Escalates to next authority level.
Documentation	Ticket system + confidential records

Staff-to-Staff Conflicts

Includes: Peer disputes, rule-breaking, abuse of power

Item	Details
Reporting	Ticket for tracking. DMs to Head Admin if sensitive.
Investigator	Head Admin(s). Neutral party if possible.
Process	Evidence review. Burden of proof on accuser.
Consequences	Warning, demotion, role removal, or ban depending on severity.
Appeal	Via ticket (may become DM conversation with Head Admin).
Documentation	Ticket system + confidential records

Staff-to-Head Admin Conflicts

Includes: Server Admin or DC Admin accusing Head Admin of misconduct

Item	Details
Reporting	Ticket + DM to remaining Head Admin(s) and Owner.
Investigator	Head Admin(s) and Owner. Accused Head Admin excluded.
Process	Full evidence review. Burden of proof on accuser.
Consequences	Same as staff-to-staff: warning, demotion, removal, or ban.
Appeal	Via ticket. Final authority: Owner.
Documentation	Confidential records with Owner oversight

Head Admin-to-Owner Conflicts

Includes: Head Admin accusing Owner of rule violation

Item	Details
Reporting	Respectful conversation initiated by Head Admin or peer.
Process	Called out privately → Private conversation → Owner considers feedback.
Authority	Owner retains final say but commits to transparency.
Accountability	If Owner erred: acknowledgment, apology, policy correction, possible gifts/restitution.
Resolution	Owner explains reasoning if decision stands. Leads by example.

Timing is Everything: Investigation Protocol

Everything can be fine, but then the "piled on" effect can upset someone and suddenly 6 months of grievances get dropped on the table. Timing reveals intent. Use this protocol to clarify whether an accusation is good faith, complicity, or retaliation.

Step 1: Identify the Trigger

Ask the accuser: "What happened THIS WEEK that made you open this ticket NOW?"

This forces them to identify the actual catalyst—not historical grudges. It reveals whether the accusation is immediate (good faith) or delayed (suspicious).

Step 2: Focus on Current Evidence

Ask: "What proof do you have of THIS incident?"

Keep the investigation narrow and current. Don't let them dilute the case with unrelated old grievances.

Step 3: Clarify Intent (If Old Evidence Appears)

If they bring up old incidents with old proof, respond with:

"Okay, I hear you. But I need to understand what's happening here. Why are you bringing all of this up NOW? Is this you coming clean about breaking rules as well since you knew and stayed silent? Or have you just had enough and want to tell us everything? Or is this retaliation for something that happened recently?"

Distinguishing Responses:

Scenario	What It Means	Action
"I'm coming clean. I knew about this and didn't report it."	Complicity. They were aware of rule-breaking and stayed silent.	Accuser faces consequences for being an accessory after the fact.
"I've just had enough. There's been a pattern and I'm finally speaking up."	Good Faith. They're reporting repeated misconduct.	Proceed with full investigation. Document the pattern.
"Well, I also remember they did..." (right after a conflict with them)	Retaliation. Weaponizing old information to hurt someone.	Accuser may face demotion or ban for malicious accusations.

Consequences & Punishments

Punishments are flexible and depend on evidence, severity, and context. The following are guidelines:

Offense Type	Consequence
Sexual Harassment / Racism (with proof)	Permanent Ban
Theft / Griefing / General Harassment	Victim refunded/repaid. Offender punished (mute, temp ban, or permanent ban)
Spam / Bickering	Mute or Temp Ban (flexible, case-by-case)
Harmful Spam	Permanent Ban
Cheating / Duping / X-ray / Hacking	Instant Permanent Ban (no appeal)
Repeated Harassment (3rd offense)	Permanent Ban
Staff Misconduct (minor)	Warning or temporary role suspension
Staff Misconduct (major: abuse, bias, etc.)	Demotion, role removal, or permanent ban
False / Malicious Accusations	Demotion, temp ban, or permanent ban (decided by Head Admin)

Gray Areas & Special Cases

Disputed Bans

If a player claims a ban was wrongful, the ban is reviewed by the staff member one tier above the investigator. They may overturn, uphold, or modify the ban.

Contested Refunds/Repairs

If a player disputes a staff decision (e.g., whether they deserve a refund), a Head Admin reviews the case. In ~99% of cases, Head Admins agree with the original staff decision, but appeals are always heard.

Harassment Patterns

Multiple complaints about the same behavior are evaluated case-by-case. Sexual harassment or racism with proof = permanent ban. Other harassment escalates: 1st offense (warning/mute), 2nd (temp ban), 3rd (permanent ban). Accusations must not be hearsay—only direct evidence counts.

Hearsay & Voice Calls

Hearsay ("I heard from someone that...") is not entertained as evidence. Voice calls are tricky but acceptable if context is provided. If an accusation relies solely on what someone claims another person said in a private call, it must be corroborated by direct evidence or testimony from the actual parties involved.

False & Malicious Accusations

If an accuser is found to have made a false or malicious accusation, they face consequences determined by Head Admins: warning, temp ban, permanent ban, or demotion (if staff). Context matters—an honest mistake is different from weaponizing accusations.

Cheating & Item Duplication

X-ray, item duplication, hacking, or other exploits = instant permanent ban. No appeal. Investigation is quick once proof is found.

Discord vs. In-Game Conflicts

If a conflict starts in-game but spills into Discord (or vice versa), staff handles the entire situation. Parties are warned to take disputes to tickets. Mutes applied if needed to prevent escalation.

Investigation Best Practices

Burden of Proof

Always rests with the accuser. It is harder to prove innocence than guilt, so accusations must be supported by evidence.

Evidence Standards

Screenshots, videos, chat logs, timestamps, and server logs are all valid. Hearsay or accusations without evidence are not sufficient.

Confidentiality

Keep investigations private. Do not discuss details in public channels. Use DMs and confidential ticket threads.

Neutral Investigation

Investigators should not have a personal stake in the outcome. If you're involved in the conflict, recuse yourself.

Documentation & Archives

All conflicts, investigations, and resolutions are documented in the ticket system. Tickets are archived indefinitely for reference and accountability. This creates a clear record for appeals and ensures transparency.